

Password Security Guide

Passwords control access to accounts, systems, and sensitive information. They're often the weakest security link due to reuse, simplicity, or poor storage habits.

Attackers bypass passwords through guessing, automated tools, data breaches, or phishing tricks.

Common password attacks

Watch for these methods:

- Brute force: Automated guessing of all combinations
- Dictionary attacks: Trying common words and passwords
- Credential stuffing: Using leaked passwords on other sites
- Password spraying: Common passwords across many accounts
- Phishing: Tricking you into revealing your password

The impact

Individuals lose access to email, banking, and social accounts, leading to financial loss or identity theft. One hacked password can unlock many linked services.

Businesses face system breaches, data leaks, and network compromise from single weak accounts.

Poor password habits

Avoid these mistakes:

- Short, simple passwords that are easy to guess
- Same password across multiple accounts
- Sharing passwords with others
- Storing passwords in plain text or notes
- Predictable patterns like names or birthdays

How to stay secure

Follow these best practices:

- Create long, complex, unique passwords for each account
- Use passphrases (multiple unrelated words)
- Enable multi-factor authentication (MFA) everywhere
- Use a password manager to generate and store passwords
- Change passwords after known breaches
- Never share credentials or write them down

For businesses

Add enforced password policies, account lockouts, and access controls.

Passwords work best with other security layers. Strong habits plus MFA and password managers provide much better protection than passwords alone.